



Call for Submissions Track Guidance

To learn more about .conf26's Call for Submissions, visit:

conf.splunk.com

Hello Splunk Enthusiast!

Call for Submissions (CFS) for .conf26 is now open!
You have until March 26, 2026 @ 11:59 PM PT to submit.

This year, .conf will be taking place in Denver! .conf26 will have all the fun, hands-on-learning and networking that's made our conference a favorite among data champions for decades. To help you create an amazing submission for .conf26, we have included a list of topics specific to each of this year's tracks — *Security, Observability, Platform, and Splunk Developer*.

Looking for Resources to Shape Your Perfect .conf Submission? We've Got You Covered!

Head over to conf.splunk.com—your one-stop-shop for everything you need to craft a submission that wows.

These resources will help guide you through your .conf submission:

Resource	What You'll Find
Title & Abstract Guidelines	Tips and real examples to help you write titles that pop and abstracts that make an impact.
Session Type Descriptions	The rundown on each session format—Technical Sessions, Panels, Interactive Workshops, and Theaters—so you can pick your perfect stage.
Session Skill Level Descriptions	Whether your audience is just getting started or has been using Splunk for years, this guide helps you dial in the right level.
Track Guidance	A deep dive into each session track to help you find your content's home—spoiler alert: you're already reading it!

.conf25 by the Numbers

5,000+ attendees from **65** countries with **400+** customer, partner, and Splunk speakers

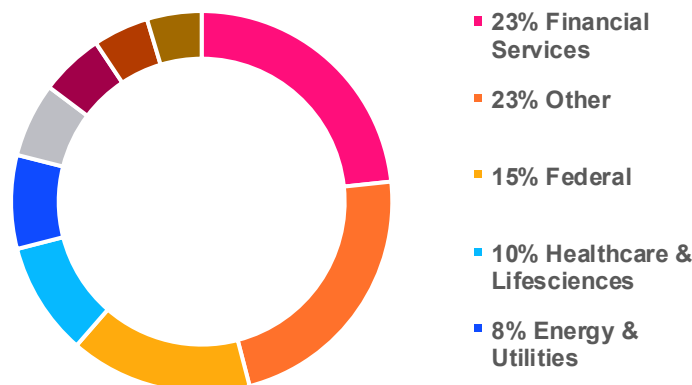
Top 10 Titles

in attendance at .conf25:

1. Security Architect/Engineer
2. Security Analyst/Manager
3. Splunk Administrator
4. Engineer, Director/VP Engineering
5. Splunk Architect
6. Director/LOB Leader
7. Executive
8. Product Owner/Product Manager
9. ITOps
10. SOC Manager/Director

Top Industries

in attendance at .conf25



Splunk Security Track

Sub-Tracks, Topics/Themes and Storylines

Powering the Agentic SOC: Unifying data, tooling, AI and TDIR to automate the mundane, clarify the complex, and mitigate risk.

The following sub-tracks, topics/themes and storylines are key for the Security Track in 2026:

Sub-Tracks

- Unified Security Operations
- Security Monitoring, Threat Detection & Detection Engineering
- Security Automation, Incident Response & AI
- Governance, Compliance & Frameworks

Topics and Themes

- Security Monitoring, Incident Management, and Asset Discovery
- Behavioral Analytics (Anomaly Detection, Insider Threats, Machine Learning, Fraud)
- AI-powered SecOps & Automation
- Unified Threat Detection, Investigation, and Response (TDIR) Workflows
- Detection & Automation Engineering
- Security Data Management & Federation (Federation, Open Data Fabric, OCSF)
- Incident Response, Threat Hunting & Threat Research
- Risk-Based Alerting (RBA) & Entity Risk Scoring (ERS)
- Governance, Compliance & Cyber Frameworks (OCSF, MITRE, NIST)

Storylines

Details

Simplifying the Analyst Experience with unified Threat Detection, Investigation, and Response (TDIR) Workflows	Unify SIEM, SOAR, UEBA, Threat Intelligence, and Detection Engineering in Splunk Enterprise Security for faster, high-fidelity detections. Shorten investigations and respond intelligently using embedded AI, reducing analyst burnout and improving security outcomes.
Prioritizing and Quantifying Risks Across Your Environment	Shift from alert overload to a risk-based approach using RBA and ERS. Integrate UEBA to surface hidden threats and Exposure Analytics to find security gaps. Leave with strategies to prioritize threats and focus your team on impactful risks.
Scaling Detection Engineering for the SOC	Master the detection lifecycle in Splunk Enterprise Security with Detection Studio. Build repeatable processes for higher-quality, faster detections. Expand threat coverage while reducing tool maintenance and response times.
Implementing Accurate and Trusted AI at Scale for Tailored Security Outcomes	Deploy trusted AI across the SOC to tailor security outcomes. Use AI Assistant for natural language queries, instant reporting, and precise triage. Get a roadmap for automating TDIR and adapting AI to your specific needs.
Unifying and Searching Security Data Where It Lives with Federation and the Open Data Fabric	Gain visibility across EDR, cloud, and network data without re-ingesting. Use Splunk's open data fabric for efficient filtering and federated search. Control data growth and maintain high-speed searches for modern investigations.
Moving Beyond Anomaly Detection to Behavioral Intelligence	Move from basic anomalies to operational behavioral intelligence with native UEBA. Surface insider threats and lateral movement using ERS, RBA, and Exposure Analytics. Turn anomalies into actionable risk intelligence.
Accelerating Investigations with Embedded Threat Intelligence	Integrate threat intelligence into every TDIR stage using data from Cisco Talos and Splunk. Automate enrichment and prioritization to reduce alert fatigue. Gain a playbook for actionable intelligence that speeds triage.
Automating Response and Coordinating Containment with SOAR	Transition from manual responses to scalable automation with SOAR. Standardize triage and containment actions, empower analysts, and ensure repeatable, high-fidelity incident response for any threat.
Proving SOC Value with Strategic Metrics and Dashboards	Focus on impactful metrics over alert volumes. Use dashboards to highlight KPIs and demonstrate risk reduction and containment benefits. Acquire a guide for aligning SOC performance with leadership goals.
Minimizing Global Regulatory Risks with Automated Governance and Compliance	Automate compliance with frameworks like GDPR and SOX. Use asset discovery and risk data for continuous monitoring. Streamline reporting, meet mandates, and turn governance requirements into automated security actions.
Standardizing Security Operations through Industry Frameworks	Apply MITRE ATT&CK®, NIST, and OCSF to unify security language and map detection coverage. Use OCSF for data normalization and faster investigations. Turn frameworks into actionable, collaborative playbooks.
Advancing Security Defense with Custom Innovation and Research	Explore custom Splunk applications and creative security solutions. Learn from Cisco Talos and Splunk research teams. Gain intelligence on emerging threats and workflows to enhance your organization's defensive strategies.

Splunk Observability Track

Sub-Tracks, Topics/Themes and Storylines

Learn how AI-driven insights help you gain business context, resolve issues faster, and control your data and costs.

The following sub-tracks, topics/themes and storylines are key for the Observability Track in 2026:

Sub-Tracks

- **Unified observability:** Correlate metrics, logs, and traces across all applications, infrastructure and business processes for full context into performance problems, their root causes and business impact.
- **AI-powered observability:** Use AI agents to automate detection, troubleshooting and remediation of performance problems.
- **Observability for AI:** Monitor the performance, quality, cost, and security of AI applications and infrastructure.
- **Understand critical user journeys:** Understand every step users take and improve digital experiences across web and mobile.

Topics and Themes

- Full-Stack Correlation for Rapid Root Cause Analysis
- AI-powered Observability
- Monitoring AI Apps & Infrastructure
- Understanding Critical User Journeys
- Monitoring Critical Business Processes
- OpenTelemetry & Scalable Data Pipelines
- Optimizing Observability Costs
- Gaining Network Visibility
- Detecting & Prioritizing App Vulnerabilities and Attacks

Storylines	Details
Full-Stack Correlation for Rapid Root Cause Analysis	Modern applications span distributed services, containers, cloud platforms, and hybrid infrastructure. When incidents occur, teams often struggle to connect signals across layers to identify the true root cause. Learn how to correlate telemetry across applications and infrastructure to eliminate silos, reduce mean time to resolution (MTTR), and resolve issues with confidence.
AI-powered Observability	As environments grow more complex, teams need faster ways to detect, troubleshoot, and resolve issues. Learn how AI-driven insights and purpose-built AI agents reduce noise, accelerate root cause analysis, and improve operational efficiency across your software stack.
Monitoring AI Apps & Infrastructure	As AI and LLM workloads move into production, challenges in behavior, accuracy, resource usage, reliability, and security quickly emerge. Learn how to monitor the performance, quality, cost, and security of your AI stack, including agents, LLMs, and AI infrastructure.
Understanding Critical User Journeys	Modern digital journeys span frontend, backend, third-party APIs, and unpredictable networks. Learn how to gain end-to-end visibility into every user interaction and optimize web and mobile experiences.
Monitoring Critical Business Processes	Without business context tied to application and infrastructure performance, it's hard to prioritize what matters. Learn how to see the impact of performance problems on business processes (checkout flows, order fulfillment, credit underwriting, etc.) and KPIs.
OpenTelemetry & Scalable Data Pipelines	Modern observability starts with how you collect, control, and route your data. Learn how to instrument applications with OpenTelemetry, manage telemetry pipelines, and build scalable, vendor-neutral observability architectures.
Optimizing Observability Costs	As environments grow more complex, data volumes and observability spend increase. Learn how leading organizations manage data growth, optimize observability investments, and scale efficiently.
Detecting & Prioritizing Application Vulnerabilities and Attacks	In software-driven organizations, application security is critical but misalignment between Engineering and Security reduces resilience. Learn how to detect vulnerabilities and attacks in application code and prioritize remediation based on risk and business impact.
Gaining Network Visibility	Modern applications rely on cloud services, third-party APIs, and complex internal and external networks. Learn how to achieve end-to-end network visibility, isolate network-related performance issues faster, and drive seamless cross-team collaboration.

Splunk Platform Track

Sub-Tracks, Topics/Themes and Storylines

Unify and analyze data at scale, anywhere it resides, powering the Cisco Data Fabric architecture to activate agentic operations.

The following sub-tracks, topics/themes and storylines are key for the Platform Track in 2026:

Sub-Tracks

- Build a Unified Data Foundation
- Search, Correlate & Analyze
- Activate AI & Agentic Operations
- Create Platform Innovations

Topics and Themes

- Eliminate the Manual Data Onboarding Tax
- Search and Analyze Data Where it Resides
- Build Edge Intelligence with Less Noise While Cutting Costs
- Deliver Executive Dashboards for Faster Decisions
- Create Trusted, Contextualized AI-Ready Data
- Build Custom AI Models on Your Proprietary Data
- Accelerate Investigations With AI-Assisted Experiences
- Activate Agentic Operations Across the Enterprise
- Trust and Govern AI with Confidence at Enterprise Scale
- Extend Splunk Across Your Tools and Platforms

Storylines	Details
Accelerate Your Journey to the Agentic Enterprise	Break down organizational silos by aligning data strategy with AI outcomes. Enable IT, security, networking, and engineering teams to collaborate on a shared, trusted data foundation. See how unified analytics and AI accelerate decision-making and operational resilience.
Create a Contextualized, AI-ready Data Foundation	Learn how you can go beyond storage with a Machine Data Lake to catalog machine data, apply semantic understanding and a knowledge graph, map issues to services and customers, and recommend consistent next steps.
Eliminate the Manual Data Onboarding Tax	Learn how to cut manual onboarding with guided setup, automated field extraction, and auto-schematization to make raw telemetry trusted and AI-ready faster using Splunk Data Management.
Search and Analyze Data Where it Resides	Learn how to analyze data in place across sources and storage to reduce duplication, lower cost and latency, and accelerate investigations and analytics.
Deliver Executive Dashboards for Faster Decisions	Learn how to build clear dashboards and reports that translate operational signals into decisions, align stakeholders, and communicate impact faster.
Turn Messy Data into Trusted AI-Ready Operational Intelligence	Make Cisco Data Fabric a flexible intelligence layer between “data everywhere” and the AI workloads you want to run—connecting and contextualizing data, using AI to analyze and act, and enforcing governance so teams move fast without losing control.
Capture What Matters, Prove Value and Optimize Cloud Spend	Learn how to optimize processing and storage to control cloud and data costs—using edge intelligence to filter noise at the source without losing visibility.
Build Custom AI Models on Your Proprietary Data	Create, test, and deploy purpose-built models with Splunk AITK—trained on your operational signals for precise outcomes and repeatable performance in production. Combine AI-driven analytics, knowledge graphs, and time-series intelligence to anticipate disruptions and predict downstream impact.
Accelerate Investigations With AI-Assisted Experiences	Learn how to use AI-assisted workflows to summarize incidents, guide next steps, and speed triage across Security and Observability with human oversight.
Activate Agentic Operations Across the Enterprise	Learn how to operationalize agents that reason, plan, and act—executing governed workflows across domains with approvals, guardrails, and auditability, while Splunk Model Context Protocol (MCP) coordinates workflows end-to-end across data sources and ecosystems..
Trust and Govern AI with Confidence at Enterprise Scale	Scale AI confidently without introducing compliance, security, or trust risks. Splunk’s governed data fabric embeds lineage, access controls, audit trails, and transparency into every assistant and agent. You will see how explainability and human oversight ensure AI decisions remain explainable.
Extend Splunk Across Your Tools and Platforms	Learn how to connect Splunk to your ecosystem to automate end-to-end workflows, trigger actions in external tools, integrate Cisco products, and embed insights across Security, Observability, and Networking.

Splunk Developer Track

Topics/Themes and Storylines

Learn how to build and monetize Splunk apps and integrations. Drive unique business outcomes with advanced customizations and unlock value.

The following topics/themes and storylines are key for the Splunk Developer Track in 2026:

Topics and Themes

- Building Apps and Agents
- Technical Add-Ons
- Custom Commands
- App Inspect / Could Vetting
- App Publishing and Monetizing on Splunkbase
- Developer SDKs
- Tooling & CI/CD incl. SCDE
- APIs
- Best Practices

Storylines	Details
Architecting the Future: Building AI Agents and Apps	Push the boundaries of automation by building intelligent agents for SOC, NOC, or Splunk administration. Learn how to use the new Python SDK in conjunction with AI-powered IDEs to create autonomous workflows. .
Extending the Ecosystem: Dynamic Tool Registration to the MCP Server	Learn how to register the unique capabilities of your existing Splunk apps to the Splunk MCP Server. This allows AI-driven experiences like AI Canvas and ChatGPT to interact directly with your tools, turning your existing development efforts into modern, AI-ready assets.
Optimized DevEx: Reimagined CI/CD and Secure Deployment	Build faster and better using the Universal Configuration Console (UCC) and SPL2. Use the Splunk Cloud Developer Edition (SCDE) to get your apps up and running instantly. Also featuring AI-powered AppInspect, ACS, and GitHub Actions to ensure your code is secure, compliant, and high-quality before it hits production.
From Code to Capital: Monetization and the Developer Program	Discover the Splunk Developer Program and follow actionable steps to monetize your apps on Splunkbase. Whether you are an individual dev or a global partner, learn the GTM strategies to bring your apps to market faster.
Best Practices: App Lifecycle, Gold Standard TAs and more	Gain expert strategies for managing breaking changes to ensure seamless, resilient app lifecycles. Master the gold standard for technology add-ons (TAs) and new capabilities to ensure app health via automated validation.
Visualizing Insights: Advanced Dashboards and UI Extensibility	Master the art of storytelling through data using Dashboard Studio and the Splunk UI toolkit. Learn how to build bespoke, high-performance visualizations and interactive experiences using the Splunk React framework.
Intelligent Orchestration: Building for Splunk SOAR	Modernize your security operations by learning how to create custom SOAR apps that orchestrate complex security workflows and automate responses across third-party technologies.

Thank you!

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